TidyTuesday Week 43

Pranay Gundam

Friday 23rd October, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where we grab two economic time series that have never met, never will, and never should, and force them into a linear regression like a reality-show producer who definitely knows what they're doing. As always, the reminder up top: these pairs are chosen at random, no causal story is intended, and if you find yourself nodding along to any of the "relationships" below, please go outside and touch a nonferrous metal.

Monday, October 19, kicked things off with a true humdinger: "Weekday-Basis Seasonal Factors for Light Truck Production" versus the "Export Price Index for Nonferrous Metal Production." The raw regression produced an R-squared of roughly 0.00003, which is my favorite kind of number because it is, functionally, zero wearing a trench coat. A p-value of 0.93 confirmed that these two series regard each other with the warm indifference of strangers on a bus. The detrended version somehow managed to do even less. Two series, utterly unmoved by one another's existence. A palate cleanser. We stan a clean null.

Then came Tuesday, October 20, which tried to convince us that Latin American agricultural import prices are deeply entangled with the checkable deposits and currency held by the 50th-to-90th wealth percentiles (discontinued, naturally, because nothing says rigor like a dead series). The raw regression lit up with an R-squared of 0.27 and a p-value of 0.0006 – oooh, significance, clutch the pearls! And then we detrended it, and the whole thing evaporated into an R-squared of 0.0008 and a p-value of 0.86. Textbook trend mirage. Two things drifted vaguely over time, the raw regression mistook "both exist in chronological order" for "love," and detrending filed the annulment papers. This is precisely the kind of result this project was built to point at and laugh.

The real headliner, though, was Thursday, October 23: the DC minimum wage versus the Peoria, Illinois house price index. The raw regression came in hot with an R-squared of 0.77 – genuinely the beefiest number of the week – and a p-value with so many zeros it looked like it fell asleep on the keyboard. For one glorious moment I almost believed DC wage legislators were personally propping up Peoria real estate. And then, as is tradition, the detrended version strode in and knifed it: R-squared 0.0003, p-value 0.91. Both series just go up over decades, as money-flavored things tend to do, and once you strip out that shared upward march there's nothing left but noise shaking hands with noise. So three pairs, three nothingburgers, zero survivors in the detrended round – which, honestly, is the most statistically honest week we could've hoped for. Draw no conclusions, trust no correlation, and I'll see you next week to do it all again.

2 Date: 2026-10-19

Series ID: G17MVSFWLTRUCKS
This series is titled Weekday-Basis Seasonal Factors: Light Truck Production and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Seasonal Factor and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2027-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: IY3314
This series is titled Export Price Index (NAICS): Nonferrous Metal (Except Aluminum) Production and Processing and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 2005=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2005-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IY3314	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.008633
Date:	Mon, 19 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.926
Time:	17:51:42	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1453.3
No. Observations:	249	**AIC:**	2911.
Df Residuals:	247	**BIC:**	2918.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	224.0975	50.852	4.407	0.000	123.938	324.257
value_fred_G17MVSFWLTRUCKS	-0.0470	0.506	-0.093	0.926	-1.044	0.950

Omnibus:	96.948	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.011
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	270.714
Skew:	1.770	**Prob(JB):**	1.64e-59
Kurtosis:	6.683	**Cond. No.**	969.

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

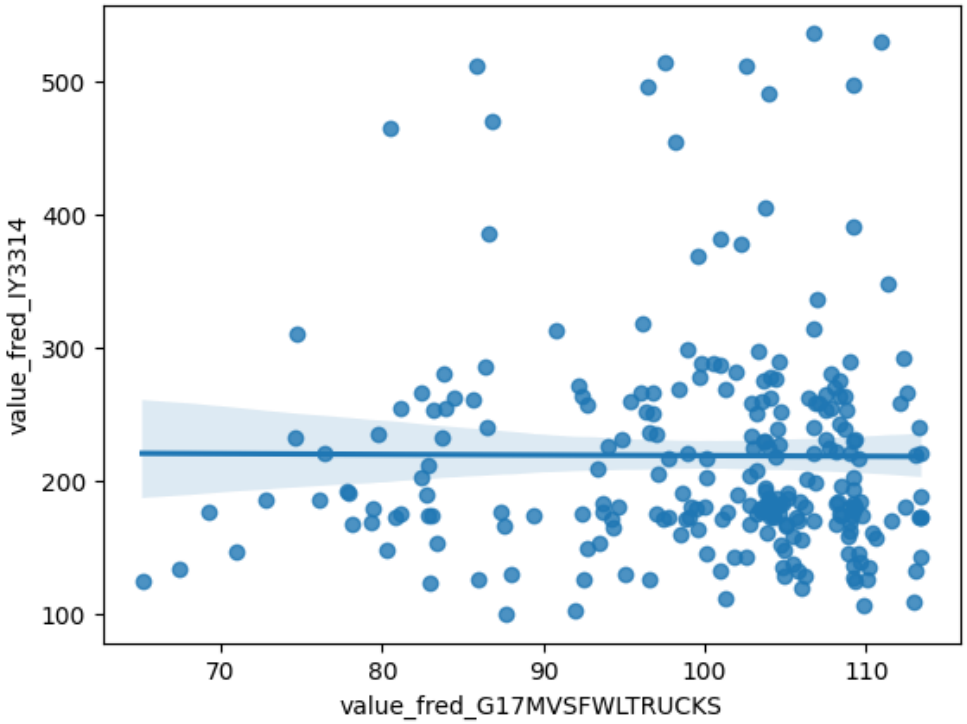


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-19

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IY3314_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.02068
Date:	Mon, 19 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.886
Time:	17:51:42	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1346.8
No. Observations:	249	**AIC:**	2698.
Df Residuals:	247	**BIC:**	2705.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-6.754e-12	3.439	-1.96e-12	1.000	-6.774	6.774
value_fred_G17MVSFWLTRUCKS_detrended	0.0475	0.330	0.144	0.886	-0.603	0.697

Omnibus:	75.189	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.024
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	174.874
Skew:	1.427	**Prob(JB):**	1.06e-38
Kurtosis:	5.952	**Cond. No.**	10.4

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

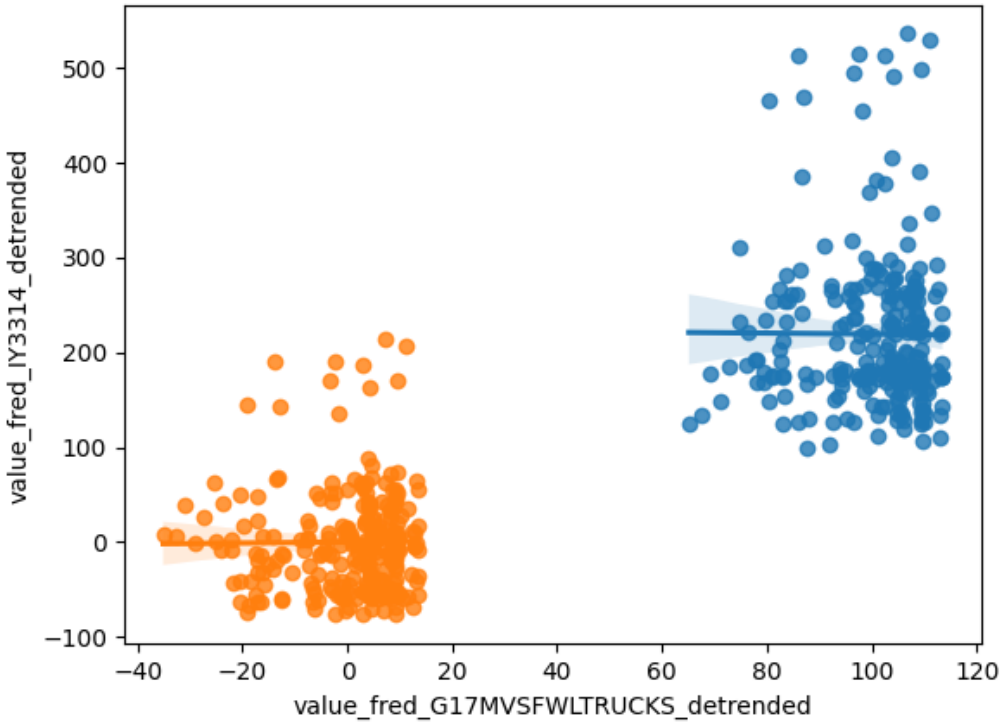


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-19

3 Date: 2026-10-20

Series ID: COLATZ11
This series is titled Import Price Index by Origin (NAICS): Agriculture, Forestry, Fishing and Hunting for Latin America and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jun 2012=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2012-06-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: WFRBLN40059
This series is titled Checkable Deposits and Currency Held by the 50th to 90th Wealth Percentiles (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1989-07-01 and the observation end date is 2022-04-01.The popularity of this series is 2.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_WFRBLN40059	**R-squared:**	0.267
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.248
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	13.87
Date:	Tue, 20 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.000635
Time:	15:55:02	**Log-Likelihood:**	-553.28
No. Observations:	40	**AIC:**	1111.
Df Residuals:	38	**BIC:**	1114.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-1.261e+06	4.72e+05	-2.672	0.011	-2.22e+06	-3.06e+05
value_fred_COLATZ11	1.62e+04	4349.040	3.724	0.001	7390.953	2.5e+04

Omnibus:	8.566	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.269
Prob(Omnibus):	0.014	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	7.873
Skew:	1.067	**Prob(JB):**	0.0195
Kurtosis:	3.413	**Cond. No.**	1.28e+03

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 1.28e+03. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

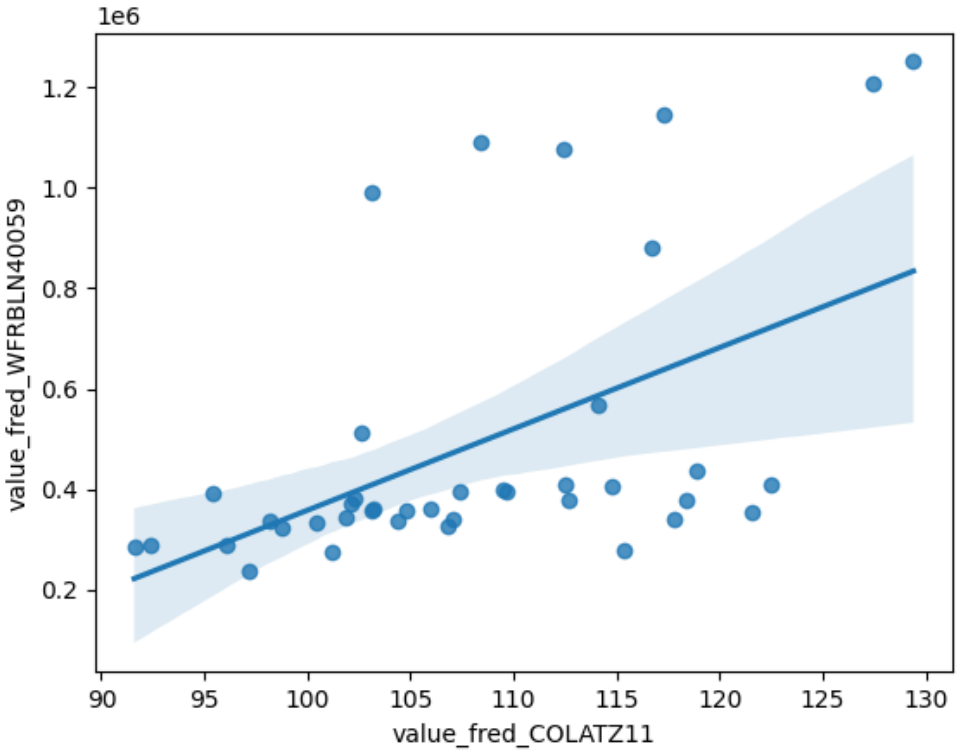


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-20

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_WFRBLN40059_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.001
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.025
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.03202
Date:	Tue, 20 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.859
Time:	15:55:02	**Log-Likelihood:**	-543.18
No. Observations:	40	**AIC:**	1090.
Df Residuals:	38	**BIC:**	1094.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-5.959e-08	3.1e+04	-1.92e-12	1.000	-6.28e+04	6.28e+04
value_fred_COLATZ11_detrended	-859.3401	4802.520	-0.179	0.859	-1.06e+04	8862.854

Omnibus:	0.421	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.106
Prob(Omnibus):	0.810	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.579
Skew:	0.150	**Prob(JB):**	0.749
Kurtosis:	2.493	**Cond. No.**	6.46

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

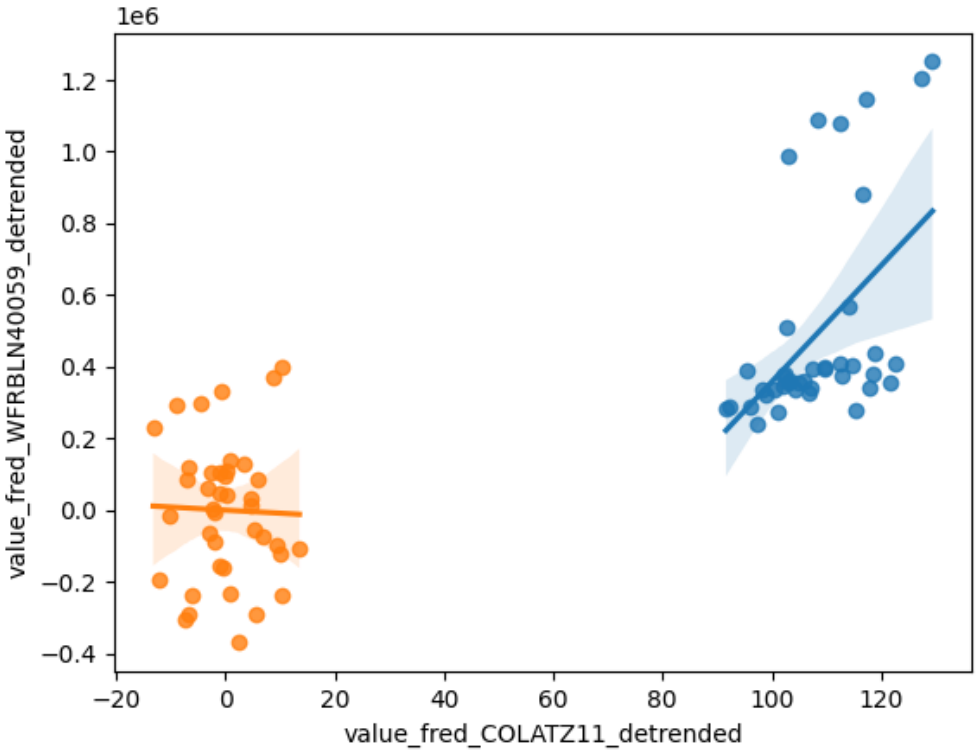


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-20

4 Date: 2026-10-23

Series ID: STTMINWGDC
This series is titled State Minimum Wage Rate for District of Columbia and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Dollars per Hour and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1968-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01.The popularity of this series is 21.

Series ID: ATNHPIUS37900Q
This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Peoria, IL (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1979-04-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01.The popularity of this series is 2.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS37900Q	**R-squared:**	0.773
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.768
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	153.3
Date:	Fri, 23 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	4.28e-16
Time:	15:59:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-215.63
No. Observations:	47	**AIC:**	435.3
Df Residuals:	45	**BIC:**	439.0
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	51.3736	7.417	6.926	0.000	36.434	66.313
value_fred_STTMINWGDC	10.0257	0.810	12.383	0.000	8.395	11.656

Omnibus:	16.895	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.093
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	3.651
Skew:	0.192	**Prob(JB):**	0.161
Kurtosis:	1.690	**Cond. No.**	19.3

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

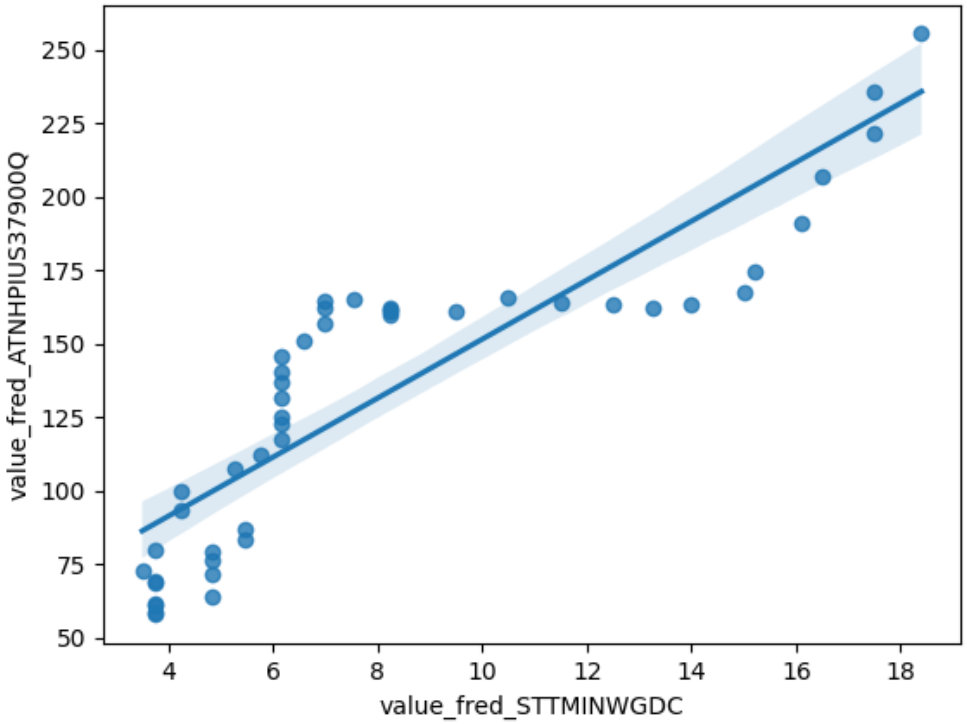


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-23

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS37900Q_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.022
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.01385
Date:	Fri, 23 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.907
Time:	15:59:09	**Log-Likelihood:**	-191.61
No. Observations:	47	**AIC:**	387.2
Df Residuals:	45	**BIC:**	390.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	1.51e-14	2.127	7.1e-15	1.000	-4.283	4.283
value_fred_STTMINWGDC_detrended	0.1420	1.207	0.118	0.907	-2.288	2.572

Omnibus:	1.830	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.176
Prob(Omnibus):	0.400	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	1.367
Skew:	0.418	**Prob(JB):**	0.505
Kurtosis:	3.012	**Cond. No.**	1.76

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

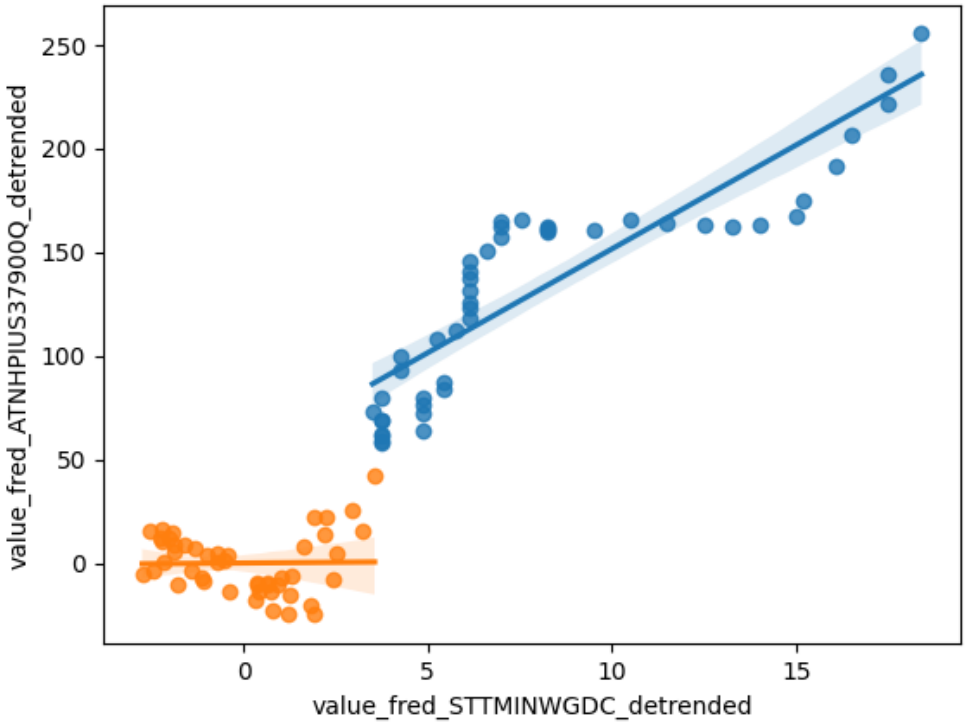


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-23